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TRANSPORTATION



Rivian sues to sell its EVs directly in Ohio

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necessary dealership licenses. (The OADA did not immediately return a request for comment.)



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“Consumer economy. C sales of veh Ohioans by up costs an administrat

Rivian has v Rivian and to sell EVs in Illinois. That state’s dealer association sued to try to block Rivian and Lucid from selling directly but ultimately failed.

Lucid Motors, meanwhile, filed a lawsuit of its own in Texas in 2022 in a challenge to that state’s direct-sales ban. The court ruled against Lucid earlier this year, but the company has appealed, federal court records show.

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Sean O'Kane — 11:38 AM PDT · March 18, 2025

IMAGE CREDITS:

JONATHAN WIGGS/THE BOSTON GLOBE / GETTY IMAGES

The most problem-free EV charging networks in the U.S. right now are the ones built by Tesla and Rivian, according to a [new survey](#) from Consumer Reports.

The publication surveyed 1,230 owners on their EV charging experiences between March 2024 and February 2024, and just 4% of the respondents said they experienced problems at Tesla's Supercharger network. Only 5% said they

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experienced problems using Rivian’s Adventure Network chargers.

Owners had the worst experience with Shell’s Recharge network, having reported a problem 48% of the time. EVgo and Blink chargers were similarly troublesome, with owners experiencing problems 43% and 41% of the time, respectively. Other well-known networks didn’t perform too well, either, with owners logging problems at Electrify America 35% of the time and at ChargePoint chargers 24% of the time. Rivian and Tesla were the only networks in single digits.

EVs made up more than 8% of vehicle sales in the U.S. last year, [according to Cox Automotive](#), and while sales growth has cooled, overall volume is still growing. People are increasingly

from Consumer Reports’ networks m behind. Rep America, a requests fo

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“By calling charging po data that will hold charging networks accountable and improve drivers’ experience with public charging,” Consumer Reports’ campaign manager Drew Toher said in a statement.

Tesla has been building out its Supercharger network for over a decade now, so it’s not surprising that it has hammered out a lot of the issues that still plague many of these other companies. And that’s great news for non-Tesla EV owners or prospective buyers, since the company has opened up the Supercharger network to [essentially all other electric vehicles](#).

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EV rivals Tesla, Rivian unite to target direct sales

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Tesla, Rivian, Lordstown Motors and Lucid Motors — potential rivals in the burgeoning EV market — are working together to pass laws that would allow direct sales in at least eight states with another batch of proposed legislation likely being introduced this year.

Passage of such legislation would clear the way for EV giants like Tesla, along with newcomers Lucid and Rivian, which have yet to bring a vehicle to market, to sell directly to consumers. However, Tesla's cooperation could also cost the company its monopoly on direct sales in some states.

Tesla and a growing number of new EV companies have a different business model than legacy automakers like GM, Ford and Stellantis. Tesla sells vehicles through their own

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branded stores — similar to how Apple sells its products — and do not have franchised dealerships. The direct sales model has attracted the ire of auto dealers, who benefit from long-established rules in all 50 states that prevent manufacturers with existing franchisees from opening their own dealerships to compete with them. Tesla and other allies argue that because they don't have franchise dealers, they should be allowed to sell directly to consumers.

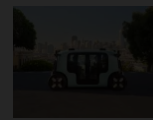
"We support our other EV-only manufacturers and their desires to sell direct-to-consumers, to invest, to create jobs and to do that unfettered as we are allowed," Thad Kurowski, senior policy manager at Tesla, said while testifying in the state of Washington during the House's Consumer Protection and Business Committee. Washington is one of many states where such legislation is being consi

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alleging theft of trade secrets and talent poaching. Rivian responded that two of the three claims in the case were nothing more than an attempt to smear its reputation.

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Tesla takes aim at Rivian in lawsuit alleging trade secret theft, poaching talent



Tesla filed a lawsuit against electric vehicle automaker Rivian and four former employers, on allegations of poaching talent and stealing trade secrets. Bloomberg was the first to report the lawsuit filed in California Superior Court in Santa Clara. Tesla alleges in the

lawsuit that Rivian recruits Tesla employees and encourages them to take proprietary information ... Continue reading

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as a public policy lead. Witt emphasized the bills are the result of efforts from the coalition of EV companies, grassroots lobbying from EV owners and EV enthusiasts and consumer groups. The legislation has also found support from environmental and clean energy groups, which argue that consumer choice and ease of access are key to helping people transition away from internal combustion engine cars.

“Any situation where the door got closed behind Tesla was not a matter of trying to gain a market advantage so much as it was just a product of the negotiations in a given legislature,” Witt said. “By and large, whether it’s New York, or Washington or Connecticut, we’re all rowing in the same direction.”

In a statement, the Tesla Owners of Washington County Dealers Association said the bill would “put the burden of transition to EVs on the backs of consumers, not on them at the time of purchase.”

“battle of Maryland.”

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the sale is made instead of reinvesting in the community,” the group said.

The organization pointed out that Rivian has garnered \$500 million in funding from Ford. Rivian, which is now valued at \$27.6 billion, has numerous backers, including Amazon, T. Rowe Price Associates Inc., Fidelity Management and

Research Company, Coatue, Cox Automotive and D1 Capital Partners.

“What would stop Ford from abandoning its dealer network, and shifting the profits dealers generate for the company out of Ford and into greater ownership of Rivian? Or GM from spinning off an EV subsidiary?” the group said in its statement.

It should be noted that, Ford nor GM has ever expressed plans to abandon its dealer network.

EV manufacturers have a long legislative road ahead of them. Bills generally must clear legislative committees and receive majority votes from both the House and Senate before being sent to the governor’s desk to be signed into law.

Early Stage entrepreneurs, some of the businesses we’ll cover recruiting, and Each session there’s ample questions a

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Rivian is building its own EV charging network, but with an adventurous twist

Work has already begun

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vehicle. The network will include fast-chargers located along interstates, a strategy employed by Tesla and Electrify America, the entity set up by Volkswagen as part of its settlement with U.S. regulators over its diesel emissions cheating scandal.

Rivian is adding a second layer to its electric vehicle charging game plan that's atypical of the industry. The company will set up dozens of EV chargers designed to power up its electric vehicles while parked at adventurous destinations, from mountain bike and hiking trails to kayaking spots and maybe even near popular climbing crags. It's a direct appeal to Rivian's customer base and one required to build confidence in the brand and electric vehicles, in general, Rivian founder and CEO RJ Scaringe told TechCrunch in a wide-ranging interview about charging, batteries and automated driving.

“We’re excited about the opportunity to create Rivian charging locations that aren’t on the interstate, that help draw you or enable you to go to places that normally are not the kinds of places that invite or welcome electric vehicles because of charging infrastructure,” Scaringe said. “We’ve spent a lot of time thinking about how you can essentially create these curated drives where, depending on your point of interest, you can pick different paths. If you want to stop midway through the trip for a one-mile, two-mile or five-mile hike, you know, here’s a route that you want to take and here’s a charging location right next to it.”

An “all of the above” approach

The Rivian consumer-facing network is essentially two-tiers that will offer fast charging along the interstate where drivers need it, and strategically located destination chargers for when speed isn’t as important. It has created what Scaringe described as a “really interesting and challenging

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Building the Rivian network has been more than a test of consumer brand awareness and real estate wits. The electric automaker, which has raised about \$6 billion, developed the tech in-house, including the high-speed DC charger.

“We haven’t talked about this really, but that charger, the power electronics module — or the backbone of those chargers — is something that we’re going to be deploying at scale,” Scaringe said, adding that the high-speed DC charger will be capable of up to 140 miles in about 20 minutes.

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This hardware, and accompanying charging software, will be most visible in the consumer-facing Rivian network. However, the platform and the hardware around it also will be used for a fleet-based product, said Scaringe.

“If you think of commercial vans, the charger and the dispenser may look a little different, but the guts of these power modules that are used to build up the charging capability are identically applied in these very different applications,” he said. “It’s one of the reasons we built all that core

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including ChargePoint, EVConnect, EVGo, Electrify America and Greenlots. Legacy automakers have created partnerships and even made strategic investments in these businesses ahead of their own electric vehicle rollouts. But Scaringe isn't willing to rely completely on third-party networks.

“The challenge is we don't control those networks, so the payments platforms, the uptime, the performance, the ability to reserve a charger — all those things that take the friction of charging away — we don't truly control,” said Scaringe. “With the Rivian Adventure Network, we have 100% control of that; we get to know what vehicles are charging or how they're charging, the rates. We can be really creative in terms of locations, so it can allow us to get to places that are very specific and unique to Rivian.”

Open or shut?

The Rivian network is clearly being built for Rivian customers. However, it doesn't mean this will necessarily be a closed proprietary system like Tesla's Supercharger network.

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The two common connectors used for rapid charging are Combined Charging System (CCS) or CHAdeMO. CCS, a direct current connector that

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2021.

"As that network is built it will take some of the pressure off the need to have the very large battery packs," Scaringe said.

Every Rivian R1T and R1S comes standard with a battery pack that has more than 300 miles of range. The company plans to make a pack with more than 400 miles of range available in the R1T beginning in January 2022. A longer range R1S with both five and seven-passenger seating will be announced following start of production, the company has previously said. Rivian is also planning to eventually offer a smaller 250-mile range pack for a lower-priced R1T and R1S.

Even without specific numbers, it's clear that Scaringe's aspirations and plans extend well beyond "dozens" of the Rivian stations.

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“The scale of a network is not something that you can turn on overnight,” he said. It takes months of time to get full coverage of the U.S. and years of time to get dense coverage, which by 2023 or 2024, we will certainly have.”

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Transportation Editor |

Kirsten Korosec is a reporter and editor who has covered the future of transportation from EVs and autonomous vehicles to urban air mobility and in-car tech for more than a decade. She is currently the transportation editor at...

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